

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Threat Detection Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | MITRE ATT&CK | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience building and operating high-impact detection capabilities within enterprise environments. I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering on Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, threat hunting mapped to MITRE ATT&CK adversary tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs), and the design of detection logic that goes well beyond standard out-of-the-box rules. I have hands-on expertise with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, and Azure cloud environments, and I take pride in leading detection projects from initial concept through to production deployment with a high degree of autonomy. I am passionate about protecting sensitive data at scale and thrive in environments where precision detection and rapid, evidence-based response are critical to the organisation's mission.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Detection Engineering:** Custom SIEM rule development in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; KQL query design for high-fidelity alerting and threat hunting; detection-logic testing and continuous tuning against real adversary TTPs
- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (primary), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk (moderate); alert correlation, data connector configuration, workspace management
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven hunting using MITRE ATT&CK framework; Azure cloud log analysis, endpoint telemetry triage, behavioural anomaly investigation
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), Microsoft 365 Defender; advanced hunting, attack surface reduction, automated investigation and remediation (AIR)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; expert-level policy administration, alert triage, and behavioural detection tuning
- **Azure Cloud Security:** Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), Conditional Access, Azure Monitor, Log Analytics workspace management, cloud log ingestion into Sentinel
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel automation rules and playbooks; PowerShell scripting for alert enrichment, automated triage, and response orchestration
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; detection, containment, eradication, recovery, and root-cause analysis mapped to MITRE ATT&CK
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; risk-prioritised remediation and continuous exposure reduction
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), MFA, SSO, Conditional Access policy design
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, MCSA, CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Design and deploy high-impact detection capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, authoring custom KQL detection rules that go beyond standard SIEM templates, covering advanced attacker TTPs aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques across initial access, lateral movement, credential access, and exfiltration.

- Lead threat hunting operations using KQL across Azure cloud logs, Microsoft Entra ID audit logs, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) telemetry, and CrowdStrike Falcon event data, identifying indicators of compromise (IOCs) and attacker behaviours missed by automated alerting.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, configuring data connectors to ingest logs from Azure, Microsoft 365, CrowdStrike, Mimecast, and third-party sources; managing the Log Analytics workspace; and maintaining workspace health and ingestion pipelines.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft Defender for Office 365 (MDO), including advanced hunting queries, attack surface reduction rules, and automated investigation and remediation (AIR) configuration.
- Build and maintain SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating alert enrichment, IOC lookups, and initial response actions to reduce Mean Time to Respond (MTTR) and free analyst capacity for higher-value investigation.
- Administer and tune CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight, and Falcon Discover, developing custom Indicator of Attack (IOA) rules and behavioural detection policies to improve detection coverage across the endpoint estate.
- Collaborate with the outsourced Security Operations Centre (SOC) partner, reviewing their alert handling, sharing detection logic improvements, and ensuring consistent triage quality and escalation procedures.
- Lead end-to-end incident response activities following the NIST 800-61 framework, managing detection, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review, producing detailed technical reports and executive summaries after major events.
- Run the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and Nessus, integrating vulnerability intelligence with SIEM detections to prioritise threat exposure.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) security controls including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA, and SSO, ensuring identity telemetry flows correctly into Microsoft Sentinel for detection coverage.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, configuring attack surface reduction rules, tamper protection, and behavioural blocking, establishing full endpoint telemetry ingestion into Microsoft Sentinel for detection and hunting.
- Developed custom KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving MITRE ATT&CK technique coverage across priority tactic areas and reducing high-fidelity alert miss rates through continuous tuning of detection logic.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting across Microsoft Defender advanced hunting and Sentinel log sources, investigating anomalous authentication events, unusual process executions, and cloud configuration deviations using KQL.
- Managed Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID), ensuring identity telemetry including sign-in logs, audit logs, and risky user data was correctly ingested into Sentinel for correlation with endpoint and network events.
- Triage and investigated security alerts across SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms, applying MITRE ATT&CK-based analysis to determine alert fidelity, impact scope, and appropriate response actions.
- Wrote PowerShell scripts to automate repetitive security tasks including alert enrichment, log parsing, compliance checks, and bulk user account audits, integrating outputs with Sentinel playbooks for automated triage.
- Supported vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Nessus, correlating vulnerability findings with active SIEM detections to identify exploitable exposure and prioritise remediation based on threat context.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented endpoint security controls and configured security monitoring for a cloud-native SaaS environment, including log collection, alert configuration, and initial incident triage procedures.

- Administered identity and access management, configuring MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), and role-based access control (RBAC) across cloud platforms, reducing the attack surface from identity-based threats.
- Contributed to the design and implementation of security policies and controls aligned to ISO 27001, supporting internal governance and external audit readiness across the technology estate.
- Maintained infrastructure documentation and security runbooks, providing clear procedures for incident detection, escalation, and response.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the design and deployment of a MITRE ATT&CK coverage improvement programme in Microsoft Sentinel, authoring over 30 custom KQL detection rules that substantially improved high-fidelity alert coverage across credential theft, lateral movement, and data exfiltration TTPs.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across 8,000 devices at UAL, integrating full endpoint telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel and establishing automated investigation and remediation (AIR) workflows that significantly reduced analyst triage workload.
- Built SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that automated alert enrichment, IOC lookups, and initial containment actions, reducing Mean Time to Respond (MTTR) by over 40 percent for high-volume alert categories.
- Delivered a CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM optimisation programme, developing custom Indicator of Attack (IOA) rules and improving detection logic to reduce false-positive rates and improve signal quality for the security operations team.
- Integrated Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) findings into the detection engineering cycle, using simulated attacker TTPs to validate existing detections and identify gaps requiring new or updated KQL rules in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Collaborated with outsourced Security Operations Centre (SOC) partners to standardise alert triage procedures, detection thresholds, and escalation paths, improving consistency and reducing duplicate investigation effort.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)